

SOC Incident Report - WarmCookie Malware Infection (2024-08-15)

Executive Summary

On 15 August 2024 at approximately 00:11 UTC, a Windows workstation was compromised by WarmCookie malware. Analysis of the packet capture identified the initial malicious download chain, malware retrieval, and post-infection command-and-control (C2) traffic. Victim identification and indicators of compromise were confirmed using Wireshark.

Victim Details

Hostname: **DESKTOP-H8ALZBV**
IP Address: **10.8.15.133**
MAC Address: **00:1c:bf:03:54:82**
Windows User: **plucero**
Full Name: **Pierce Lucero**

Malware Family

WarmCookie (identified through extracted DLL analysis and corroborated by VirusTotal/Any.Run references in the exercise answer guide).

Attack Chain

1. User downloaded ZIP archive (Invoice 876597035_003.zip).
2. ZIP contained malicious JavaScript.
3. JavaScript downloaded a DLL payload.
4. DLL executed using **rundll32 filename,Start**.
5. Malware established HTTP C2 communication with 72.5.43.29.

Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

Victim:

10.8.15.133 / DESKTOP-H8ALZBV / plucero

Malicious Infrastructure

104.21.55.70 - quote.checkfedexp.com
172.67.170.169 - business.checkfedexp.com
72.5.43.29 - HTTP C2 Server

Downloaded ZIP SHA256

798563fcf7600f7ef1a35996291a9dfb5f9902733404dd499e2e736ea1dc6fc5

JavaScript SHA256

dab98819d1d7677a60f5d06be210d45b74ae5fd8cf0c24ec1b3766e25ce6dc2c

DLL SHA256

b7aec5f73d2a6bbd8cd920edb4760e2edadc98c3a45bf4fa994d47ca9cbd02f6

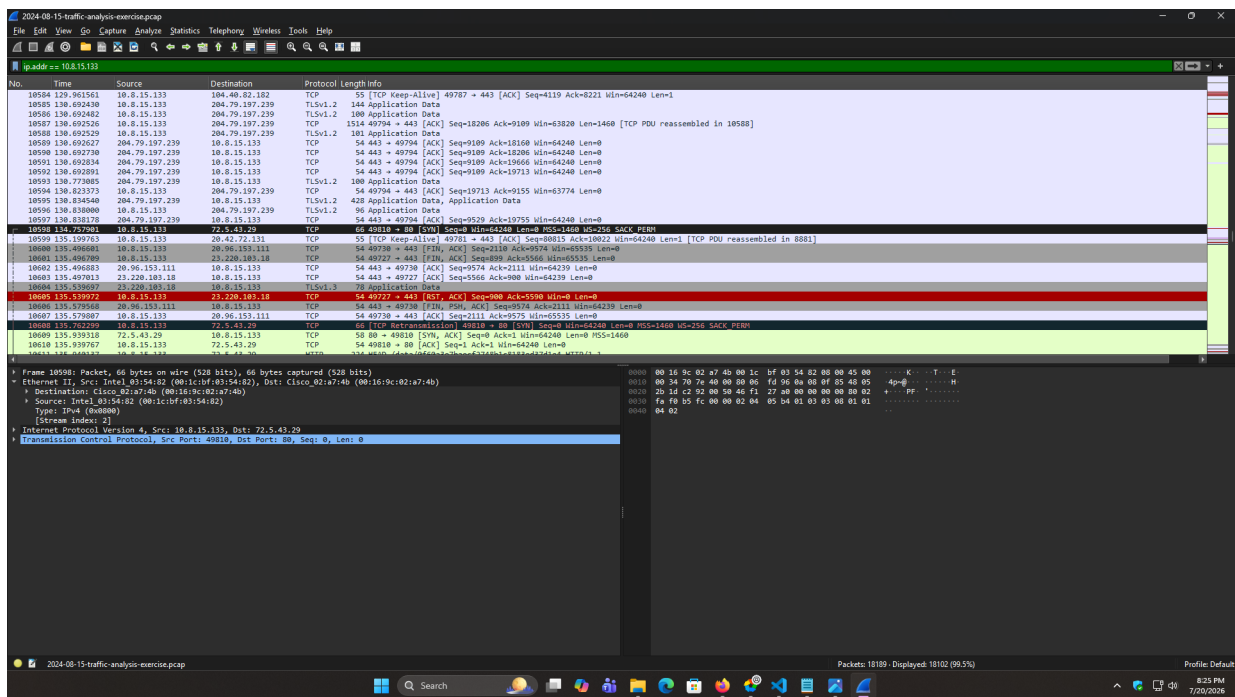


Figure 1. Victim IP traffic and outbound communications.

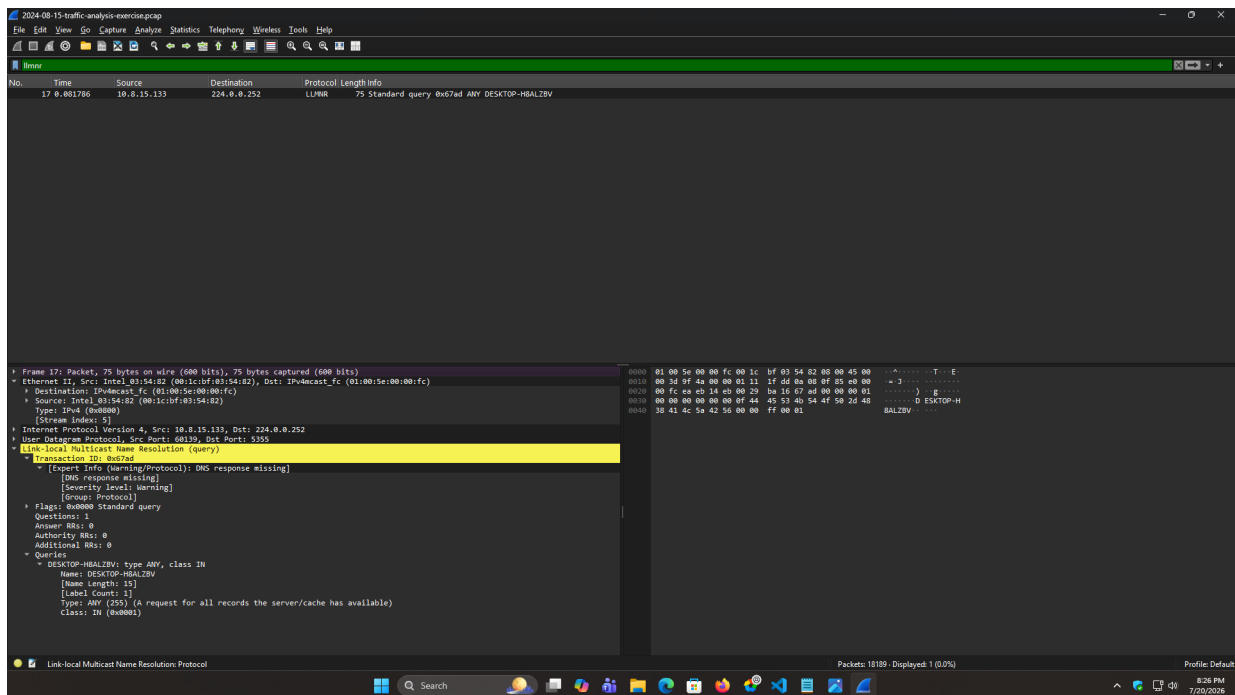


Figure 2. LLMNR identifies DESKTOP-H8ALZBV.

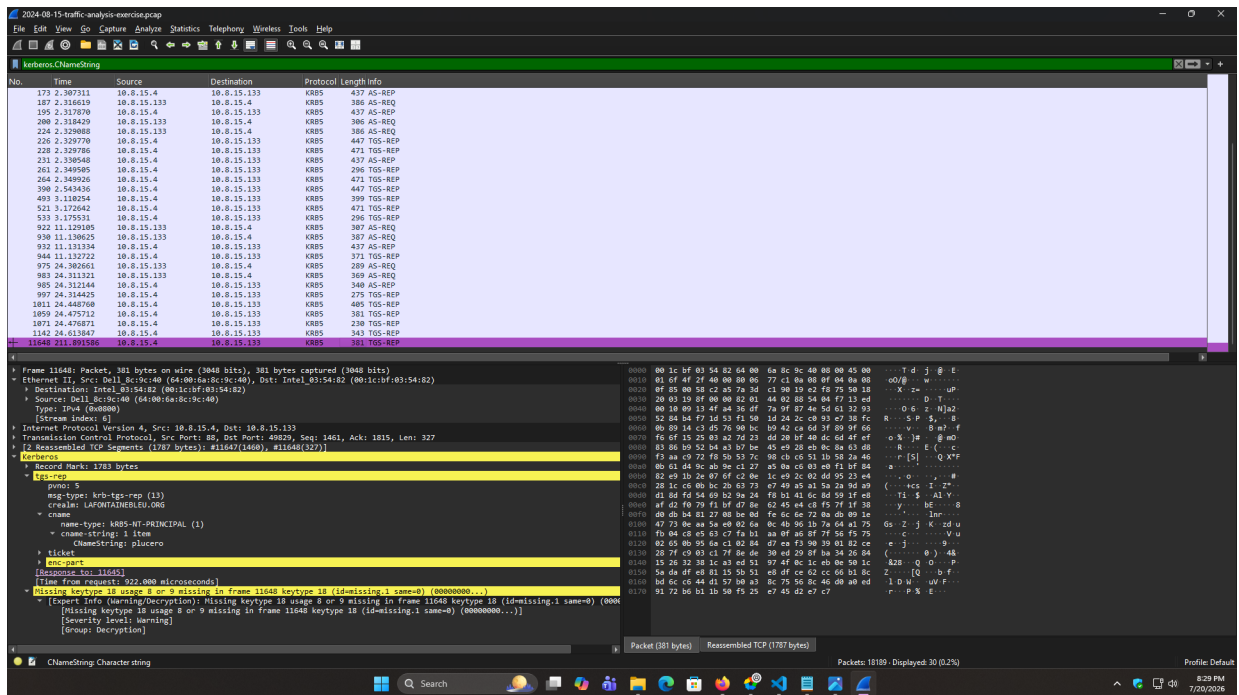


Figure 3. Kerberos identifies user account plucero.

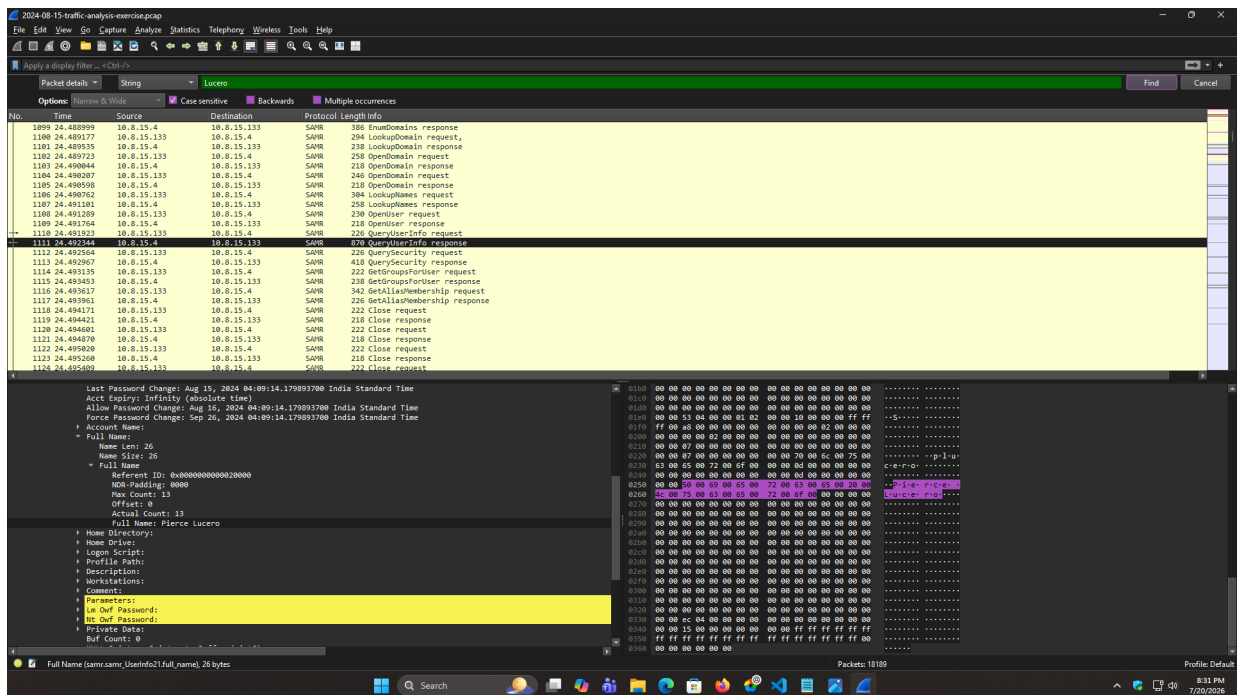


Figure 4. SAMR QueryUserInfo reveals full name Pierce Lucero.

Conclusion

The packet capture demonstrates a complete malware infection chain beginning with a malicious ZIP archive, followed by JavaScript execution, DLL retrieval, execution via rundll32, and subsequent HTTP command-and-control communications. Victim identification was validated using LLMNR, Kerberos, and SAMR artifacts. These findings support classifying the incident as a confirmed WarmCookie malware infection.